

Is C.AI Bad for the Environment?

Posted by u/Molluskkkkkk • 0 points • 9 comments

I haven't seen any discussion on this, maybe because it's obvious, but I know that ai generators like ChatGPT are extremely bad for the environment as opposed to using a typical search engine like Google; so it makes me think, is C.ai just as bad? Worse? Does anyone know more about this?

Comments

u/sniepje • 1 points • 2025-11-05 09:01 UTC

Sending one prompt compared to one google search is apparently worse. But now when I look on google I ALSO get an LLM generated answer + the normal google results. So I dont know anymore.

Also C.ai isnt like google searching for me. Id like to know it compared to average free time consumption. A book thats printed and transported, if you read it only once and it takes you 10 hours. Is that more damaging than spending 10 hours on the app? How about a warm bath. Eating chips in front of the tv. Playing a heavy computer game. Going anywhere in your car. Basically every hobby requires resources.

Also, if you include the free time activities of the mega rich, I dont think our C.ai use is visible if you zoom out enough to see the effect of pleasure yahts and private jets.

I dont have kids and dont eat much meat, which I use as an argument to convince myself I am allowed C.ai. not saying people with other lifestyles arent allowed to ise it. Im only mega harsh on me, you can do whatever you are comfortable with and I wont judge.

I struggle with mental health. And if I am too harsh on myself I need more resources to recover. Its hard to measure but sometimes little things like c.ai have an effect on keeping a job, paying taxes that can be used for environment, medication use, avoiding a food binge or some other kind of meltdown in which you undo all the hard work of denying yourself things.

Yeah, so, I dont know statistics. I can only make things more complicated, not clear them up. Sorry.

I mostly mean, do what you can, not everything. But you didnt even ask for advice like this. You wanted real hard data maybe. Sorry again. I just need to write this to convince myself sometimes.

u/Crazyfreakyben • 5 points • 2025-11-04 12:55 UTC

Not as bad as ChatGPT, but pretty close. C.ai models are so low power that it doesn't affect the environment as much as any other AI site, but it still does reasonable damage.

u/ze_mannbaerschwein • 8 points • 2025-11-04 12:51 UTC

It's about as bad as Reddit, TikTok and YouTube. Being AI based doesn't make it a worse polluter than any other data center.

u/Human_being_08896 • -1 points • 2025-11-04 13:31 UTC

AI on the scale of OpenAI and DeepSeek are much worse than any major site like Google, YouTube, ect. Generative AI is so much more resource-intensive than a search engine and the only reason it seems bigger is that these sites haven't been around as long.

u/ze_mannbaerschwein • 7 points • 2025-11-04 13:40 UTC

This only applies to the model training phase. During normal operation, AI does not consume more energy than data centers for streaming services or social media.

u/Human_being_08896 • 1 points • 2025-11-04 20:22 UTC

Pretty sure Generative AI still does, unless it's just ripping off other art.

u/jaquayvi0ntav1us • 4 points • 2025-11-04 13:33 UTC

AI is relatively new technology tbf. There'll probably be improved ways to maintain servers later down the line.

u/Human_being_08896 • 1 points • 2025-11-04 20:23 UTC

Agreed, we always seem to look at something, call it the most advanced thing ever then immediately improve it, like nuclear weapons.

u/NightmareEx • 8 points • 2025-11-04 12:47 UTC

Generative AI in its current form is bad for the environment. It's not just CAI, but GPT, Claude, Deepseek, etc.